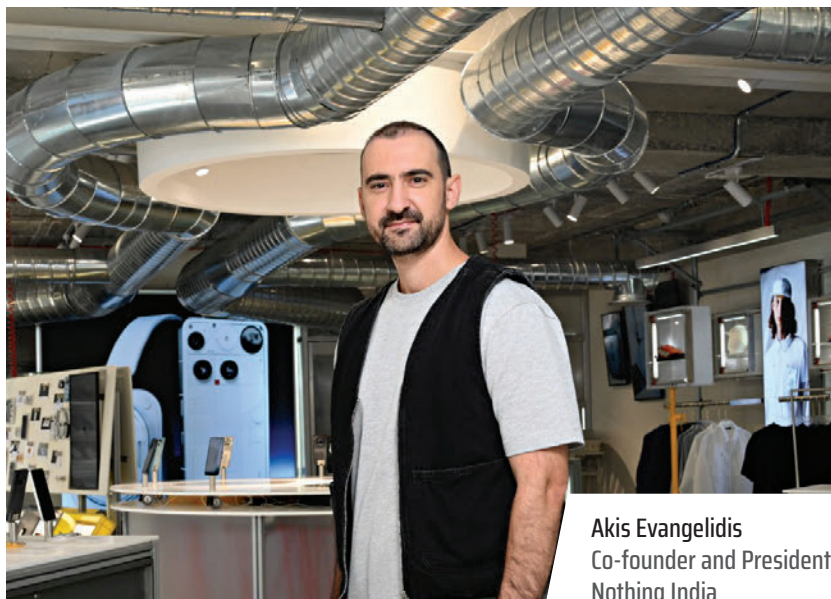




Akis Evangelidis
Co-founder and President,
Nothing India

Nothing wants India to lead in design

Next Jony Ive could come from here, says Nothing's Akis Evangelidis

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London-based smartphone brand Nothing is betting big on India not just as a consumer market but as a creative powerhouse as well. In an interaction with **Times Now Tech**, co-founder Akis Evangelidis said India is not just about engineering talent anymore, it could very well produce the next Jony Ive. And Nothing India's President believes that the shift is already happening.

Be it global chip companies or local smartphone brands, everyone relies heavily on Indian engineers. But according to him, this is only half of the story. "I think India has been seen as having a lot of engineering talent and so on but there is also a lot of creative talent, and hopefully we'll find the next

Jony Ive here," he said. According to the Nothing co-founder, India's creative ecosystem is evolving fast. Young consumers today care about design, self-expression and brand identity – not just specs and pricing. "I feel people underestimate creative talent. We are already seeing many designed brands like Gully Labs and Comet emerging," Akis added.

This shift is also creating big space for brands like Nothing to stand out. "We came into India with a different approach. Not just value-for-money specs, but design, experience, and something that feels unique," he said.

Akis stressed that the next phase of India's tech growth will be led by design not just engineering. He also

talked about how Indian consumers are changing. Earlier, most buyers focused on specifications like RAM, processor, battery and price. Now, according to him, there is a growing segment that values aesthetics and user experience more.

He compared Nothing's journey with India's own growth story.

"Sometimes I feel our journey mirrors India's growth as a country. Over the last five years, India has changed a lot. You can see it in the youth – their fashion, brand choices, and cultural confidence," Akis said.

According to him, younger consumers, especially in a market like India, want something that reflects their personality, something that stands out – something that is expressive and different. Instead of simply buying another value device, a lot of users are going for a Nothing phone when they get their first salary.

"India today is where China was 10 years ago. For us, this is a huge opportunity. We want to contribute by bringing design expertise and product capabilities," he added.

Akis also mentioned that iPhone-maker Apple has been poaching several members from Nothing, specifically their design team. "I definitely believe we have the best industrial design team in the world. I think proof of that is that Apple has been poaching a lot of our guys," he said.

He also talked about the future of smartphones and the role of artificial intelligence in it. According to him, Agentic AI is going to completely change how we use smartphones. Instead of apps, phones in the coming years will start doing things for you.

"Today, we open apps and do tasks manually. In the future, AI agents will handle tasks in the background. Smartphones won't just be tools anymore, they will become assistants that understand intent. Instead of searching and switching between apps, you will simply ask, and the phone will execute," Akis explained. **d**